

Chick enters the Hall of Fame (cont.)

height of respect for them I really have, from the first ball I ever kicked they gave me nothing but good, they have been completely behind my career, in Galway, everywhere. I've played badly, I've had injuries, I've been sent off, they've never said one bad thing.

I have the utmost respect for them, I really have, and not alone are they good journalists, they are good family men and I regard them as my true friends, and I say that from the bottom of my heart, and I am very honoured to receive an award selected by them.

When I look back now, I don't think of all the medals I won or lost - and I lost two good ones, missing out on the Cup final with Galway United and a European Cup medal with Villa - I don't think of those things at all, I think of all the friends I made, and I hope I made a few enemies as well because if I didn't, I didn't do my job right, and to be honest if I was to go back, I'd make a lot more enemies.

The amount of goodwill I have received since I was nominated for this award has been overwhelming, both in Ireland and across the water - my head is so big now I couldn't get in the Ardilaun tonight, and I am very grateful for that. I'd also like to thank all my friends, and also my family, my wife Mary, my children, my sister Mary, my brothers, my nieces, my cousins, my nephews, for the

wonderful support they have given me, on the field of play and off the field of play, without them I wouldn't be the person I am today, and I wouldn't be here receiving this award tonight.

On behalf of all the sports stars here tonight I'd like to thank all their parents, all their friends, their coaches and their managers for the wonderful support and encouragement they have given.

Finally, this will probably be the last award I receive, and I'm going out on a good one, and although the night is young I'm already looking forward to next year's awards, as I know I won't be getting anything!

Thank you very much."

Galway Sports Stars 2011, Saturday January 21, 2012, Ardilaun Hotel, Galway.

It was Eamonn's fourth Galway Sports Star award, having being named as the soccer winner in 1972, 1977 and 1981.



Hall of Fame award recipient Eamonn Deacy with his family at the Galway Sports Stars banquet in the Ardilaun House Hotel in January of this year. He is pictured in the front row with his wife Mary O'Connor and his daughter Dawn, along with Nicola and Andrea Deacy. Middle row: George Deacy, Georgina McHale, Mary O'Reilly, Geraldine, Peggy and Michael Deacy. Back row: Jake, Michael Jnr, Don, Neil and Ernie Deacy and James O'Loughlin. Photo courtesy Iain McDonald



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... to win (cont.)



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The Dyke United team of Deacy brothers, managed by their father Miko, which played in the Claddagh Fives in the 1960s. Back row, from left: Jack Keady (referee), Don, Eamonn (RIP), Dessie (RIP) and manager Miko (RIP). Front: Michael, Ernie and Neil. Photo courtesy Don Deacy.

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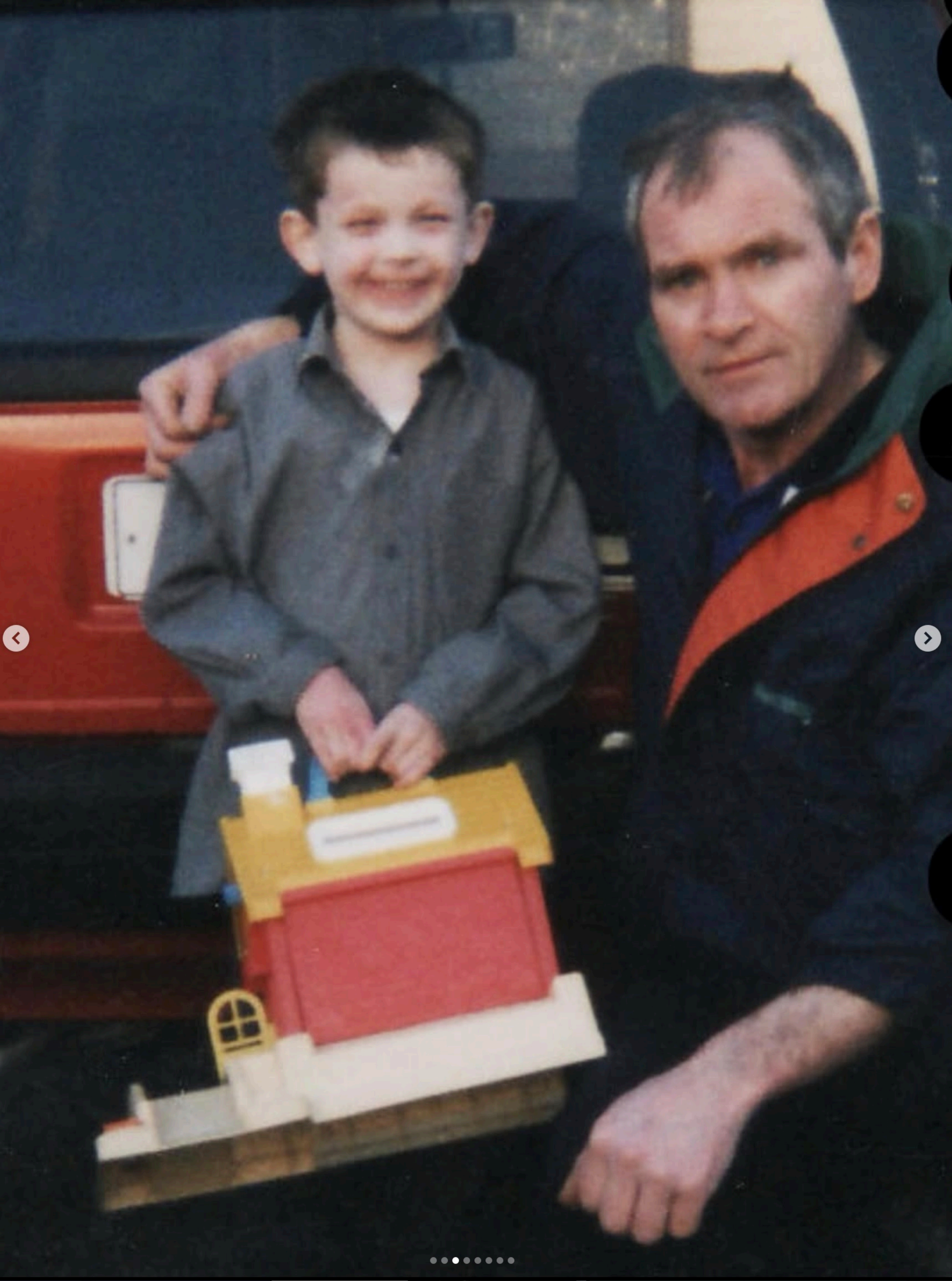
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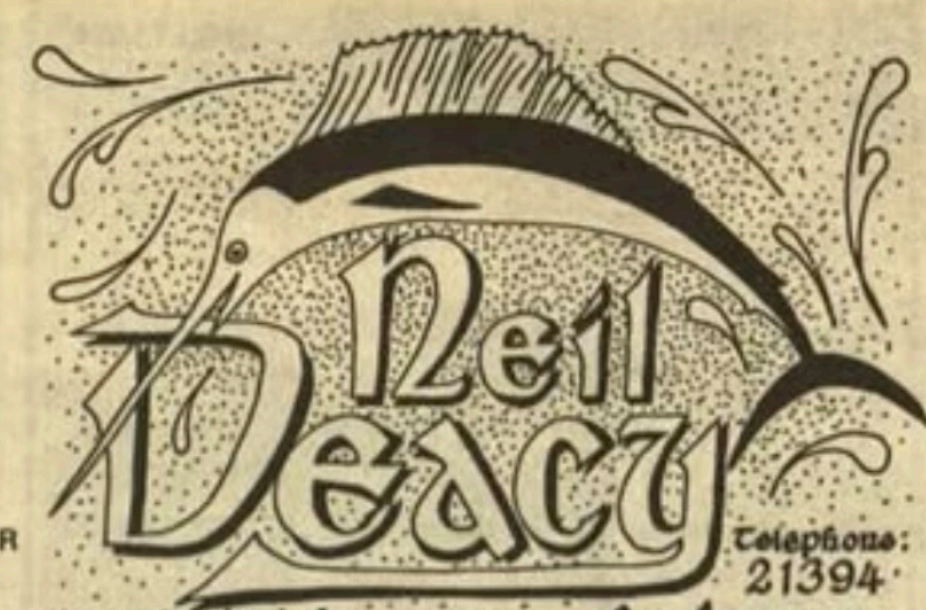
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Niall Mac an Deisi
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anois agus siar."

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of the Fish Shop that never
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